Theme 4: Travel and Transport



Across Cultures: Spain & the Shanghai Maglev

Lesson 4-6
Book pages 60-64

💡 **Big idea:** **Spain** lies on the Iberian peninsula; Muslims ruled much of it and built beautiful palaces such as the **Alhambra** in Granada. In **Reading for Pleasure** we read about the **Shanghai Maglev**, a train that floats above its track and reaches **431 km/h**.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Learn facts about Spain and its Muslim heritage
- Read about the maglev train
- Compare transport options
- Review the theme glossary

📖 Key words

peninsula شبه جزيرة	**monarchy** نظام ملكي	**maglev (magnetic levitation)** الرفع المغناطيسي	**guideway** مسار التوجيه
friction احتكاك	**non-polluting** غير ملوث	**pioneer** رائد	**benefit** فائدة
railway track سكة حديد			

Spain facts

- Capital: Madrid
- population: 47.27 million
- currency: Euro
- Spain and Portugal make up the Iberian peninsula
- Muslims of Arab and Berber origin built palaces like the Alhambra in Granada
- Over 50 million tourists visit Spain every year
- Writer Miguel de Cervantes wrote Don Quixote

The Shanghai Maglev

- Maglev = magnetic levitation
- it floats 10-15 mm above the track
- Started on 1 January 2004
- the first high-speed long-distance maglev in the world
- Top speed 431 km/h
- 30 km to Longyang Road in under 8 minutes (taxi: about an hour)
- Advantages: cheaper maintenance, less friction, non-polluting, uses less energy, very safe
- It cost 1.2 billion dollars



The Shanghai Maglev Train (p.62)

✏️ Examples

Why are maglev guideways long-lasting?

Answer: Because there is no contact between the train and the guideway, so there is no friction.

Who built the Alhambra Palace?

Answer: Muslims of Berber and Arab origin.

⭐ Remember

- Compare facts in a table: speed, cost, journey time, environment.

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ The maglev runs on wheels. ✓ It floats above the guideway using electromagnets.

🧩 **Activity:** Write notes for visitors about the main festivals and events in Oman for your portfolio.

✅ Check yourself

1. Capital of Spain?
2. What does maglev stand for?
3. Top speed of the Shanghai Maglev?
4. Where is the Alhambra?

Answers: (1) Madrid ، (2) magnetic levitation ، (3) 431 km/h ، (4) Granada